

Proposal Memo

Checkpoint 1

This week marks the first major checkpoint of your semester-long Sports Analytics portfolio project.

In this Proposal Memo, you will officially propose your project topic, define the problem you plan to address, and outline your intended approach. This checkpoint ensures your project is feasible, well-defined, and grounded in real data setting the foundation for the rest of the semester.

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Overview

Each student (or team) will submit a professional proposal memo (~1 page) that introduces their project idea, identifies a dataset, and outlines a high-level plan for analysis.

Group Work Option

You may work in groups of up to 3 students, but each student must maintain their own GitHub repository for this project (we'll cover setup in a later checkpoint). You are encouraged to collaborate on the same topic, share data, and divide tasks.

Assignment Objectives

By completing this checkpoint, you will:

1. Select a feasible sports analytics topic and define a clear research question or problem.
2. Identify a relevant dataset or data source that can address your question.
3. Explain why your topic matters and who benefits from the insights.
4. Outline a preliminary analysis plan at a high level.
5. Practice writing in a clear, concise, professional memo format.

What to Include in Your Memo

Keep your memo around 1 page, single-spaced. Use professional tone and formatting suitable for a stakeholder audience.

Section	Description	Guiding Questions
Project Title & Topic Summary	Provide a working title and a 1–2 sentence overview of your topic or question.	What is your project about, in plain language?
Problem Statement & Relevance	Describe the problem or question you'll address and why it matters.	Who cares about this problem, and why? What is the real-world sports context or impact?
Intended Dataset (Source & Description)	Identify the dataset(s) you'll use (or plan to obtain). Explain what the data contains and why it fits your question.	What's your data source? What does it include (sport, season, variables)? How will you get it?
Initial Plan or Method	Outline how you might analyze the data at a high level.	What kind of analysis do you envision - statistical comparison, predictive modeling, simulation, visualization?
Next Steps	Describe your immediate plans after submitting the proposal.	What are your next 2-3 actions (obtain data, clean it, refine question, gather feedback)?

Feel free to use headings or bullet points **within your memo** to organize these sections, but ensure the memo reads as a professional narrative (not just an outline). The tone should be formal yet concise, as if you are writing to a project supervisor or stakeholder interested in your analysis.

Submission Details

Requirement	Details
Document Type	Google Doc (professional memo format)
Submission	Share the Google Doc link on Google Classroom
Format Tips	Include your name and project title at the top, as well as any group members

Grading & Rubric (10 points total)

Your Proposal Memo will be evaluated on the following criteria:

Criteria	Description	Points
Clarity of Problem Statement	Clearly defines a focused, specific question or problem that is easy to understand.	2
Feasibility of Topic & Data	Topic is realistic for the semester, and data is suitable or obtainable.	2
Relevance & Significance	Explains why the topic matters and identifies key stakeholders.	2
Structure & Professional Tone	Organized, well-formatted, and written professionally (as a memo).	2
Writing Quality	Clear, concise, grammatically correct, and polished.	2

Additional Notes

You do not need to submit your GitHub repo yet, just ensure you know how to create one for later checkpoints.

Choose a topic you care about; passion often leads to better analysis and presentation later on!!